



GP2X

What is it?

The GP2X is a video game console and media player. It is hand-held and Linux-based. Using the GP2X, you can view photos, read e-books, watch videos, listen to music, play games, import games from other systems, and use games developed on your own. It runs on two 200 MHz CPUs, 64 MB of RAM, and 64 MB of Flash memory. It has a 320 x 240 backlit LCD with custom graphics hardware and a TV-out.

When was it released?

The initial release was the GP32, in 2001. Later—in 2005 to be precise—it was reincarnated as the GP2X.

Who will use it?

Game lovers—both gamers as well as developers—are the target users.

Why is it special?

The GP2X can connect to a TV, enabling games to be played on a big screen. The scaling chip allows movies to be resized and played without re-encoding. Being Linux-driven, there are a lot of software (games, emulators, PDA applications, multimedia players) and tools freely available, which enable the development of new games and applications. The emulators allow one to run a host of software from other systems. And, it just needs two AA-sized batteries.

How easy is it to develop games for GP2X?

The SDK is included with the system. The GP2X source is available for Windows and Linux developers at the GP2X site. More libraries with their source are provided at the GP2X developer's forum and elsewhere on the Net.

Where is it being sold?

30,000 units have been sold worldwide. Right now it seems to be very popular in the UK and Europe. The UK price is £124.99 (Rs 11,000)!

Yergaliyev, 19, said in an interview with CNET News.com. "I never do it, but (this time)..."

So what's of interest here? Note that Yergaliyev is one of Digg's top-rated users, and you'll get a hint. We're referring to *Time*'s Lev Grossman talking about this year going down in history as the time when "the many wrestling power from the few."

Sounds rosily socialistic—socialistic in a positive sense, as in actually working—but it seems to us far from the truth.

Technorati.com has a drop-down menu that lets you search for blogs "by authority." So where's the many who are wrestling power from the few who have the "authority" on Technorati? Would you read something by Robert Scoble of Scobleizer fame, or something by someone with a name like geeky_butterfly? And why do we need the Web to teach us this—ever heard of a "journalist of repute"?

Similarly, Amazon.com has a rating system for its reviewers. Naturally, and correctly, you'll read the reviews of a high-rated reviewer with more credulousness. The many are down there; the few are right up there in the rankings.

This isn't a space for a political discussion; our point is that there will always be the few and the many, and the latter will never "wrest power." Web 2.0 creates its structures and hierarchies very well indeed—it's as good a watchdog as any of the old-world status quo.

A FRESH ATTEMPT

Will EVD Make It?

Yet another format, but one we've spoken about earlier. EVD—Enhanced Versatile Disc, or Enhanced Video Disc,

depending on whom you ask—is like a Phoenix rising from the ashes! It will revolutionise HD delivery! That's what China would have you believe!

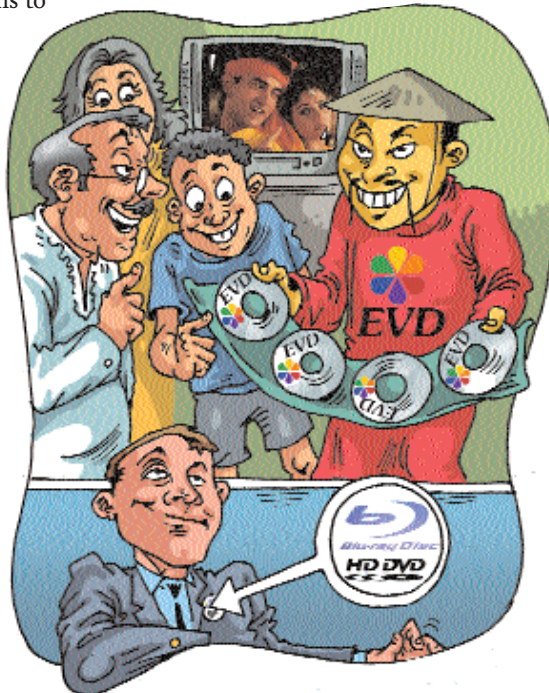
Exclamation marks aside, Chinese manufacturers are sick of paying intellectual property royalties for most of the DVD players they manufacture, which is a lot—80 per cent of the world's total. Now EVD—China's home-grown format—was being pushed before as an alternative to HD-DVD and Blu-ray, and interest somehow fizzled out; it's back now, not with a bang but with what sounds to us like a whine. ("Please buy our dirt-cheap discs and players!")

Technically, EVD is not a blue-laser technology like HD-DVD or Blu-ray; it's red-laser, like DVD, and is touted to be its successor. China plans to

though, say more than two layers will be difficult.

This whole thing holds some import for us for three reasons. First, it's already out: 6 December, several of the players were on display at a Beijing art gallery. (Several titles have been released too, most of them Chinese.) Second, the players are cheap—lower than the \$100 price point. And third, they will in all probability be targeted at Indian audiences—and which Indian doesn't like the ring of the word "cheap"?

Now China has attempted peddling its stuff to the world before. Cases in point are S-VCD, its telecommunications standard TD-SCDMA, and WAPI (WLAN Authentication and Privacy Infrastructure), a Chinese national standard for Wireless LAN. None of these made it big worldwide, and



phase out DVD altogether by 2008. EVD is essentially DVD that uses a more efficient compression system. But EVD's developers have said in the past they would try and merge the format with London-based New Medium Enterprises' VMD (Versatile Multi-Layer Disc), a red-laser system offering 50 GB on ten 5 GB data layers. Analysts,

didn't make too much of a dent even in Chinese markets.

Of course, we shouldn't be extrapolating, and this time round, EVD might just cut it. But most analysts are saying "no," and state media have reported that the EVD players have fared poorly in tests. Hedge your bets now! ■